Great question ⍰ Let's carefully break this down.

Difference between Container, Web Server, and Application Server

Component	Definition	Role	Example Use Case
Container	A lightweight, portable unit that packages an application and all its dependencies (runtime, libraries, config) into a single environment. Runs on container engines like Docker or Podman.	Provides **isolation** and portability of applications across environments.	Running a Spring Boot app in Docker for portability across Ubuntu, AWS, Azure, and GCP.
Web Server	Software that serves **static content** (HTML, CSS, JS, images) and handles basic HTTP requests. Can also act as a **reverse proxy** to application servers.	Handles **HTTP requests** and delivers static files to browsers.	Nginx serving a React frontend, or Apache HTTPD hosting static sites.
Application Server	Software that provides an environment to run **dynamic, server-side applications** (Java, Python, PHP, etc.). Usually supports APIs, business logic, transactions, and session management.	Executes **application logic** and connects to databases, APIs, and services.	Tomcat or WildFly hosting Java apps with APIs.

List of Containers, Web Servers, and Application Servers compatible with Ubuntu 22.04, AWS, Azure, and GCP

Category	Name	Ubuntu 22.04	AWS	Azure	GCP	Notes
Containers (Engines & Orchestration)	Docker	✅	✅ (ECS, EKS, EC2)	✅ (AKS, VM)	✅ (GKE, Compute Engine)	Most widely used container runtime

	Podman	✓	✓ (EC2, custom images)	✓	✓	Daemonless, Docker-compatible
	containerd	✓	✓	✓	✓	Core container runtime used in Kubernetes
	CRI-O	✓	✓	✓	✓	Kubernetes-focused container runtime
	Kubernetes (K8s)	✓	✓ (EKS)	✓ (AKS)	✓ (GKE)	Orchestration for containers
Web Servers	Apache HTTP Server (httpd)	✓	✓	✓	✓	Popular open-source web server
	Nginx	✓	✓	✓	✓	High-performance web server + reverse proxy
	Caddy	✓	✓	✓	✓	Auto HTTPS, simple config
	Lighttpd	✓	✓	✓	✓	Lightweight web server
	IIS (Windows only)	✗	✓ (Windows Server on EC2)	✓ (Windows VM)	✓ (Windows VM)	Not natively supported on Ubuntu
Application Servers	Apache Tomcat	✓	✓	✓	✓	Java servlet/JSP container

	WildFly (JBoss)	✅	✅	✅	✅	Java EE application server
	GlassFish	✅	✅	✅	✅	Java EE reference implementation
	Jetty	✅	✅	✅	✅	Lightweight Java app server
	WebLogic (Oracle)	✅	✅ (Marketplace)	✅ (Marketplace)	✅ (Marketplace)	Enterprise Java EE server
	WebSphere (IBM)	✅	✅ (Marketplace)	✅ (Marketplace)	✅ (Marketplace)	Enterprise-grade, heavy server

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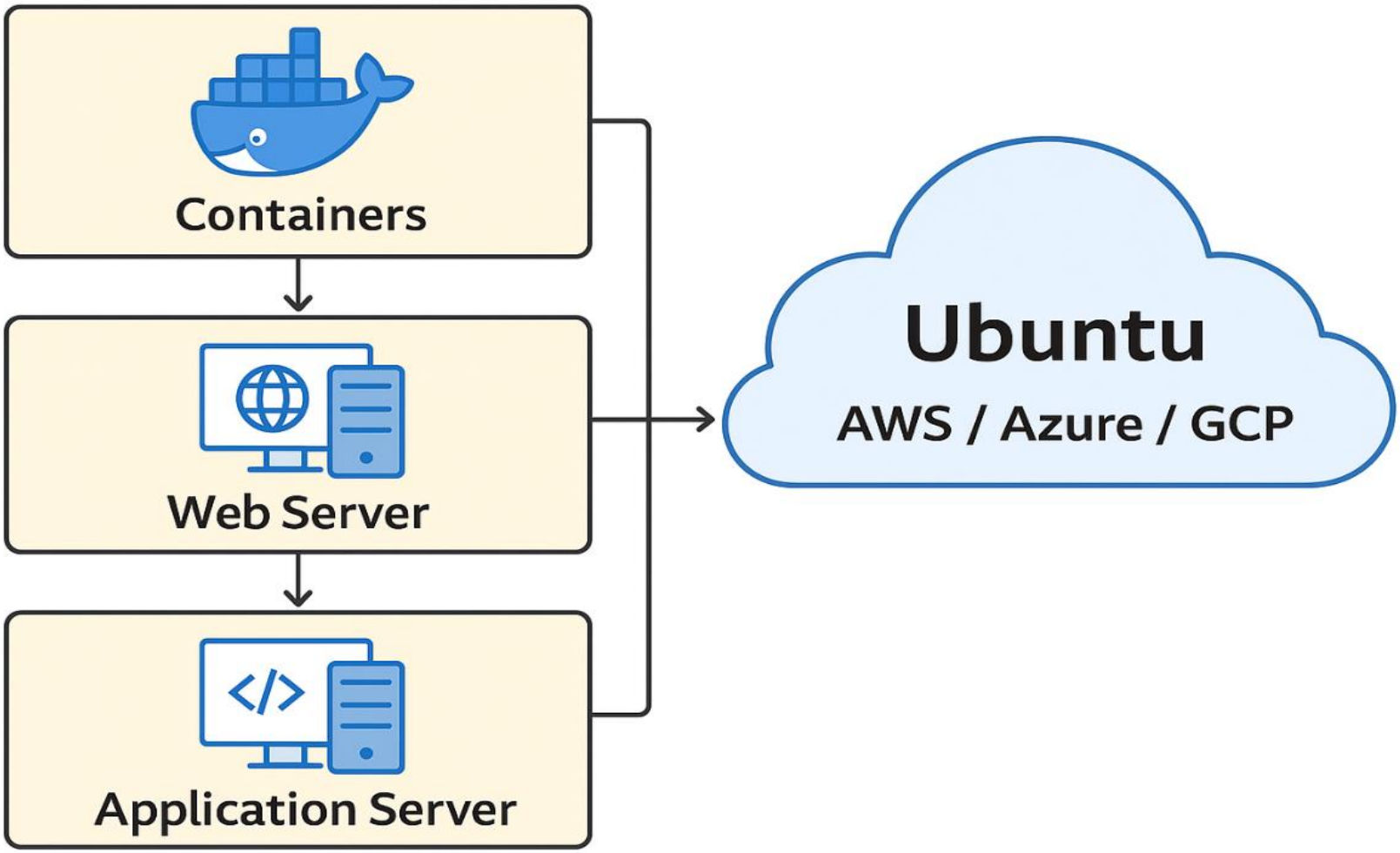
✅ means **fully compatible and supported** on that platform.
❌ means **not natively supported** (but possible via VM/container hacks).

Would you like me to also create a **visual diagram** showing how these three (containers, web servers, application servers) fit together in a **typical cloud deployment (Ubuntu + AWS/Azure/GCP)**?